



Squirrel monkey

MONKEYS

Monkeys are primates. It is easy to tell them apart from the smarter primates, people, and apes, because they have tails. Some, such as mandrills, live on the ground, but most monkeys are light enough to jump or swing through the trees.

They always look before they leap, though, because there is danger all around. Large eagles may swoop down from above and leopards lurk below. If they miss their footing, monkeys may plunge up to 200 feet (60 meters) to the ground!

Keep it clean!

These rhesus monkeys are lining up to have insects and dirt picked out of their fur. They even pick one another's teeth clean! This grooming helps to keep them tidy and also good friends.



Built to balance

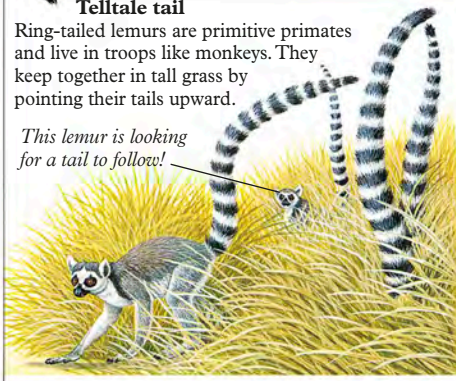
If you start to lose your balance, you can use your arms to steady yourself. Monkeys use their tails instead—leaving their arms free for climbing.

Groups of monkeys are called troops.

Telltale tail

Ring-tailed lemurs are primitive primates and live in troops like monkeys. They keep together in tall grass by pointing their tails upward.

This lemur is looking for a tail to follow!



Mandrill (male)



Proboscis monkey (male)



Bald uakari



Cotton-top tamarin